

BRIDGING THE DIVIDE

With deep ravines to bridge and mercurial great rivers that defied control, building secure railway bridges on India's constantly shifting, alien terrain was a Herculean task. Most times, the rivers were almost dry streams with wide beds, but then the rains transformed them into untameable torrents that threatened to engulf structures built to cross them.



▲ **This 960-m-long bridge** accommodates a railway line on top and a road below. It is estimated that roughly 70,000 cubic metres of masonry and brickwork was used in its construction.

India's traditional bridges were small and usually built over narrow, manageable streams. The construction of permanent structures to cross the mighty Ganges, Jamuna, Indus, or Sutlej, were never given much thought, mostly because of their changing water levels and swift